

You said it...



Congratulations to the *LFY* team for making the New Year issue special. I am a 10+1 computer science student and I'm very interested in open source software. The articles and features about the Fedora 10 are excellent. As I'm interested in networking I have managed to get a load of information about the subject.

The CD team has done a very good job. All the software is very useful. The *Tips and Tricks* section is also very good. I have a request: could you try and include the Ubuntu Ultimate edition 2.0 and some graphical repositories? Hope the magazine improves by reducing spelling mistakes.

—Anirudhan Adukkathayar,
by mail

ED: Thanks for your feedback Anirudhan. We're glad that you liked the January issue and find the topics that were covered useful. Also, though the editing team does its best to avoid spelling and other factual errors, some escape our notice—we're all human after all. It'd be wonderful if you keep us informed about the errors you notice so that we can mention them in our 'Errata' section, if required.



I read a really cool article in the December 2008 issue of *LFY*—about how to create a portal with session cookies (cached on the client, and dynamic) and it helped me understand how cookies function. I have always had some doubts on how it works, but now I am very clear. I am trying to set up a portal on a Fedora 10 box, but have lost the magazine. Can you please let me know how I can get a copy of *LFY*'s December 2008 edition to continue working on my home set-up?

—Gopal, by e-mail

ED: The PDF of the article has been sent to you by e-mail. In case you want to order older issues you can always ping the chaps at kits@efyindia.com. :)



I definitely enjoyed reading Sarath Lakshman's article titled, "udev Unplugged" in *LFY*'s Dec 2008 issue. Great work! I did want to point out, and ask about a couple of things: 1. A possibly useful addition: After one has edited/added rules into */etc/udev/rules.d/<somefile.rules>*, the changes/additions generally don't take effect until the *udev* daemon is told to refresh its rules. This can be done by running the following command, as the root:

```
# udevcontrol --reload_rules
```

2. A query to the author: I don't know if it's just me, but the 'RUN' command does not seem to take effect on my Ubuntu box. I run Ubuntu 8.04.1 on the 2.6.24-22-generic kernel. The rule I added is as follows:

```
# Backup Disk: Transcend USB SATA 160GB disk
SUBSYSTEM=="block",ATTR(dev)=="8:17",ATTR(s
tart)=="65",ATTR(size)=="312576642",RUN+="/
usr/bin/notify-send --urgency=normal --expire-
time=5000 'BACKUP DISK inserted (Transcend
160GB)...',SYMLINK+="bkpdisk"
```

The thing is, the soft link */dev/bkpdisk* is created, but the RUN command is not getting executed. (I also tried substituting the above command with an executable shell script, with the same result.) A very similar problem is alluded to at ubuntuforums.org/showthread.php?t=733615, where in the thread the author subsequently states that using full pathnames within the RUN command solved the problem. It does not seem to work with me. Any ideas?

—Kaiwan N Billimoria, by mail

Sarath replies: Regarding the first point, I don't think it is required. Because the latest versions of *udev* searched all the rules in */etc/udev/rules.d/* for matches, every time. I just tried it now and verified this. Reloading the daemon is not really required. You can restart *udev* if required by running *'/etc/init.d/udev*

reload' as the root. The *udevcontrol* command doesn't seem to be in Ubuntu 8.10.

Here is one problem with *RUN+= "/usr/bin/notify-send*. We cannot call *notify-send* like that. Because, first of all, 'notify-send' is user-specific and requires the display argument (environment variable: DISPLAY); and second, it depends on the dbus-session, which is different for each user.

If you look at my article, you will find a link like the following one:

```
DISPLAY=0 su $user -c 'notify-send "Backup
Complete";
```

Whatever rule you call from *udev* is run as root and its environment settings are different. We have to specify it explicitly. So I have specified the display setting as *DISPLAY=0*. Moreover, since *dbus* is used, you have to specify the user name. So, you have to run *notify-send* as the specific user for which you want to display a notification. So it is better to use a script as *RUN+= argument*.

Modify your above code as:

Rule:

```
SUBSYSTEM=="block",ATTR(dev)=="8:17",ATTR(st
art)=="65",ATTR(size)=="312576642",RUN+="/usr/
bin/pendrive.sh",SYMLINK+="bkpdisk"
```

File: */usr/bin/pendrive.sh*

```
#!/bin/bash
DISPLAY=0 su username -c '/usr/bin/notify-send
--urgency=normal --expire-time=5000 "BACKUP
DISK inserted (Transcend 160GB)..."
```

It will work. You can verify this by attaching RUN with some other independent utility.

Thank you for your queries :)

Please send your comments or suggestions to:

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